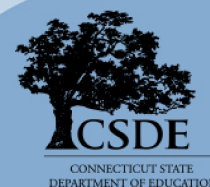


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



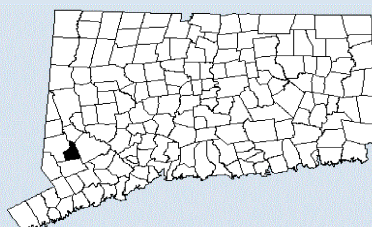
Bethel School District

Dr. Christine Carver, Superintendent • 203-794-8601 • www.bethel.k12.ct.us

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	3,089
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$15,968
Total Expenditures ¹	\$50,906,480

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,467	47.5	48.4
Male	1,622	52.5	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	242	7.8	5.2
Black or African American	109	3.5	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	686	22.2	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	93	3.0	4.0
White	1,928	62.4	49.9
English Learners	182	5.9	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	984	31.9	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	413	13.4	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	159	10.9	13	0.9
Male	194	12.2	34	2.0
Black or African American	15	13.6	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	107	15.4	16	2.2
White	199	10.6	26	1.3
English Learners	45	23.1	6	2.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	189	20.3	23	2.1
Students with Disabilities	103	24.9	15	3.1
District	353	11.6	47	1.5
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 39

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	201.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	37.2
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	50.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	7.0
School Level	10.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	5.0
Support Staff	4.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	11.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	18.0
School Nurses	6.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	117.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.4	0.1
Asian	2	0.7	1.3
Black or African American	1	0.4	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6	2.1	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	276	95.5	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.0	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	8	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	70.0	34	89.5
White	98	71.5	159	92.4
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	32	61.5	59	89.4
Students with Disabilities	16	69.6	40	85.1
District	147	70.7	230	92.4
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	25	42.4
Emotional Disturbance	10	47.6
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	107	74.8
Other Health Impairment	47	73.4
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	30	93.8
District	228	63.0
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	59	1.9	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.5
Learning Disability	143	4.7	5.8
Other Health Impairment	64	2.1	3.3
Other Disabilities	54	1.8	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	43	1.4	1.9
All Disabilities	389	12.8	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	8	2.1	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	10	2.6	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$31,752,590	\$9,960	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$3,574,414	\$1,139	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$3,768,302	\$1,200	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$544,344	\$173	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,584,587	\$823	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$2,305,585	\$734	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$3,970,273	\$1,265	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$2,406,386	\$750	\$1,159
Food services	.	.	\$21
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$151
Total	\$50,906,480	\$15,968	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,353,220	28.9	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,307,095	11.3	11.1
Other Salaries	\$2,270,429	19.6	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,019,400	17.4	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$440,301	3.8	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,306,660	11.3	22.5
Supplies	\$44,879	0.4	0.5
Property Services	\$140	0.0	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$840,517	7.2	7.2
Equipment	\$10,195	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$1,282	0.0	0.1
Total	\$11,594,119	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		22.8	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	81.1
State	16.7
Federal	2.1
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	51	96.1
English Learners	10	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	85	95.3
Students with Disabilities	31	87.1
District	228	96.5
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	94.8	96	45.5
Male	88.2	111	45.1
Black or African American	90.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	88.5	31	39.7
White	92.6	146	47.2
English Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	89.0	30	25.4
Students with Disabilities	67.1	7	10.0
District	91.2	207	45.3
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	80.0	95.4
Male	59.2	85.1
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60.0	84.0
White	71.7	90.9
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.2	89.1
Students with Disabilities	51.5	*
District	69.1	90.2
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	11.6%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	19.9%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	82.5%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	45.3%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		90.8%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		96.5%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		91.9%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		69.1%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		60.7%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.9%	2.1%	9.8%	N

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The words, "Our primary purpose is to improve student achievement" appear at the entrance to each school. Our goal is to ensure that by the time our students graduate, they are prepared to compete with anyone, anywhere for any opportunity. Our district work is driven by our strategic plan. This plan, found on our district website, was developed and continues to be monitored by teachers, parents, administrators, community members, and elected officials. That plan contains three major focus areas, action steps, and accountability measures. We have also developed a Vision for a Graduate or global competencies to ensure our students are prepared to be successful within a globally competitive workforce. Each of our five schools write School Improvement Plans, aligned to our Strategic Plan.

Through strong teaming structures at every level, we employ a highly collaborative approach, anchored in student learning data, to drive instructional change and improvement. This collaborative approach begins with pre-school. Teachers work together to assess our learners and tailor instructional plans to meet individual student needs, both in terms of remediation and acceleration. We have worked to establish a strong intervention system in literacy, mathematics, and behavior to provide interventions when gaps are identified at the earliest level. The district has supported the implementation of a coaching model to enhance regular classroom instruction. The district has expanded the positions of "specialists" (math and literacy) to create more opportunities for interventions, to address academic gaps. With an increased number of students who are English Learners, we have been committed to hiring certified EL staff to assist with language acquisition. We see the use of technology as one of the primary drivers for improving, enhancing, and personalizing instruction. We have implemented a 1:1 model in grades Pre-K - 12. In the past few years, we are implementing a districtwide STEM vision, to support already strong arts and music programs. In addition, we have developed six (6) pathways at Bethel High School to prepare our students for the global workforce. Our students have proven to be highly successful in extra-curricular competitions. Advanced Placement courses along with opportunities to earn dual credit at neighboring colleges have enabled many of our students to earn significant numbers of college credits prior to graduation.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The racial, ethnic, and economic makeup of the Bethel Community continues to evolve. In-migration of families from foreign nations and neighboring communities requires continuous review of school programs and academic services to ensure valid inclusion of all students into the school system. Special programming for parents of children who do not speak English, attempts to provide information in multiple languages, evening classes for non-English speaking parents, and tutoring for children have proven to be effective in reducing isolation. We continue to improve our efforts. Over the past several years, the Board of Education and district have set goals to develop an inclusive learning environment, actively working on actions to reduce unconscious bias and systemic racism within our schools. We provide multi-tiered, intensive reading, mathematics and behavioral interventions with the goal of having all children at grade level. We are in the process of training all of our school staff in restorative practices. We have instituted programs to enhance the cultural competence of our students and staff. We have also been focused on expanding district social-emotional learning initiatives (Pre-K-12). A range of clubs coupled with a significant service-learning program directly attack any evidence of social, racial, ethnic or economic isolation that might remain in our community. Extensive work is done to address cyberbullying and online behavior. New policies and regulations, coupled with staff training and required digital citizenship courses for students aim to teach all community members responsible technology use.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Bethel School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The budget is viewed as a statement of our educational & leadership philosophy expressed in dollars. The budget is an opportunity for the Town, school system, and its citizens to debate & set priorities aligned to our Strategic Plan. Construction of a school budget in the Bethel Public Schools entails a high level of staff involvement. Each principal leads a committee of teachers to establish funding priorities for the coming school year. School budgets are developed to address specific academic initiatives & student needs. We ask, "How will these funds improve student achievement or expand opportunities for our children?" School administrators examine all aspects of the educational & extra-curricular program and follow the process through the Superintendent's recommendation to the BOE and Town Meeting. Both the Superintendent & BOE examine carefully the proposed appropriations to each school to ensure a clearly defined/equitable allocation of resources. Because the Bethel budget process involves an independent Board of Selectmen & Board of Finance, a Town meeting, and an annual referendum, all constituents focus close attention on each dollar expenditure.